

All the PM's Men

MARCH 8, 2010

The supremacy of the PMO in the Manmohan era brings out the evolutionary story of a shadowy institution that shapes the prime ministerial vision.



“Unable to assert his authority during Cabinet formation, Manmohan Singh had to establish a brains trust in his PMO. The chosen men are low-key but high-performing bureaucrats.”

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

Men of the Moment

No doubt the prime minister's men play a key role in deciding what the Government's policies should be ("All the PM's Men", March 8). But Manmohan Singh also has to face an extra-constitutional authority in Sonia Gandhi. Congressmen have been creating the impression that it is she who runs the country. Whenever the Government does something commendable, the credit goes to her. For instance, Finance Minister Pranab Mukherjee has raised the prices of petroleum. This has been opposed by many UPA constituents. If at all the prices are rolled back, the credit would be given to Sonia, not Mukherjee.

A. SRIKANTIAH, Bangalore

The Manmohan Singh of UPA II is clearly a man who



Nightmare in the Making

Despite the qualms of recalcitrant states and politicians with vested interests, and the fears of unavoidable collateral damage, Home Minister P. Chidambaram will have to pursue a muscular policy to take on the Maoists ("Raising a Red Flag", March 8). Any further delay will lead to a situation like the LTTE in Sri Lanka that will require ruthlessness to make the writ of the state run.

BISHAN SAHAI, via www.indiatoday.in

The information on the gargantuan area affected by the Maoists is astounding. The home minister should call upon the state governments to work unflinchingly on jointly formulated strategies to annihilate the menace.

INDU SHANKAR, Varanasi

survives on his own credentials. His policies vis-à-vis the economic meltdown and Indo-US nuclear deal seem to be the prime reason that the coalition was back in power. He has begun restructuring India's security team and sharpened his policy on climate change. His unambiguous line on Pakistan shows his determination to take the issue head-on. To sum up, he has put the right people in the right job and this has paid rich dividends.

G.S. RAO, Bangalore

The trusted advisers of the prime minister who have shaped the prime ministerial vision have, in fact, miserably failed to shape his agenda in his second innings. Manmohan Singh's image has been severely dented for his failure to check price

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE, CONTACT: Customer Care, India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (Uttar Pradesh)-201301.

Phones: 2479900 from Noida, 95120-2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad, and 0120-2479900 from Rest of India.

Toll Free No.: 1800 1800 100. Fax: 0120-4078080. E-mail: wecare@intoday.com